

File No. 245(5)g/36

Collection No.

1936.

Government of India,

External Affairs Department,

General Branch

Pros.
Serial Nos. 1-6

Subject.

Proposed Locust investigations in Oman and
Dhofar by Mr. R.C. Maxwell - Darling of the Imperial
Institute of Entomology, London.

Previous References.

F.245(3)g/36

Later References.

File No. 245(5)-G/1936.

File No.

Section.

Heading.

Serial No.

NOTES.

E. A.
P. & P. DEPT.
"G" BRANCH.

Pros.

19 . . Nos.

Subject.

Proposed locust investigations in Oman and Dhufar
by Mr. R.C. Maxwell-Darling of the Imperial Institute of
Entomology, London.

Notes and orders.

S. 1.

Extract of notes a file of the Imperial Council of Agricultural Research Dept, No. F.18(1)/36-L.B., regarding locust investigations to be carried out in the Iranian territory along the coast of the Persian Gulf.

(Notes in the I.C.A.R. Dept)

A copy of Sir Guy Marshall's letter dated the 18th June 1936 is enclosed. This Dept would be glad if the F. & P. Dept would advise in the matter. The I.C.A.R. will probably be able to depute a locust Entomologist in the Iranian Gulf if the Iranian Govt would cooperate.

2. A copy of a further letter from Sir Guy Marshall dated the 9th July 1936 is also enclosed. It is requested that if there is no objection, the local authorities concerned may kindly be instructed to afford necessary facilities to Mr. Maxwell Darling. We shall be glad to be informed of the action taken.

Sd. N.C. Mehta,
8-8-36.

= Pages 2-3 info

+ Pages 3-4 info

-2-

Copy of a D.O. letter dated the 18th June 1936 from Sir Guy Marshall, C.M.G., D.Sc., F.R.S., Director, Imperial Institute Entomology, Cromwell Road London, to the Secy., Imperial Council of Agricultural Research.

1. I have to acknowledge the receipt of your letter No. F.18(1)/36/L.B. of the 21st May, and regret we are not yet in a position to give precise replies to the questionnaire on locusts that was enclosed. But the existing general information on the nature of the coastal areas of Iran, while admittedly very fragmentary, leaves no doubt that the conditions favourable to locust breeding, such as are observed on the Mekran coast in British Baluchistan, also extend along the Iranian Mekran. The necessity of exploring the Iranian coasts is therefore abundantly clear and the urgency of this problem has been stressed by the United Kingdom delegation in their draft resolution submitted to the Fourth International Locust Conference held at Cairo in April last. This resolution was approved by the Conference, but following the usual practice of such recommendations, it was suggested that the area in question should be investigated by the Iranian Govt.

2. As is well known to the Council, investigations on locusts can provide reliable information of practical value only if they are undertaken by an expert entomologist with a thorough personal knowledge of the Desert Locust and its ecological requirements. No such entomologist is available to the Iranian Govt, and there is little hope that they will undertake investigations of that kind.

3. There appears therefore only one solution, namely, that a survey of the whole Iranian coast should be undertaken by the Govt of India, by agreement with the Iranian Govt, since no final solution of the locust problem in India can be reached until that coast is investigated. Excellent results obtained by the Indian Entomologists in the investigations within their own country suggest that there can be no difficulty in finding someone with the requisite qualifications. The area to be covered by the survey should extend all along the Iranian coasts of the Arabian Sea and the Persian Gulf. As regards the coastal areas of Arabia enumerated in the questionnaire, their survey is included in the programme of

- 3 -

investigations by the Imperial Institute of Entomology and some of the areas will be visited by our locust entomologist this year. If the suggested survey of the Iranian coasts can be undertaken by Indian entomologists, the results could be linked up with our work in Arabia and on the African coast of the Red Sea, thus giving a connected picture of the whole danger zone.

As regards the questionnaire, it appears doubtful if replies given to it by persons without special knowledge can be of great scientific value. It should be borne in mind that the information necessary for the discovery of the original outbreak centres refers to solitary locusts, which are either not noticed by ordinary observers, or not considered to be locusts at all. Moreover, certain areas in Southern Iran are known to be subject to outbreaks of the Moroccan locust, and the information supplied by correspondents will probably in many cases refer to that species, while often it will be impossible to decide which species is meant

Copy of d.o. letter dated the 9th July 1936 from Sir Guy Marshal to the Secy, Imperial Council of Agricultural Research.

= above

In my letter to you dated 18th June on the subject of the locust investigations to be undertaken in Southern Iran and Arabia, I mentioned that one of our entomologists intends to survey some of the Eastern Arabian coastal areas this year. As he is at present working in the Aden Protectorate and Hadramaut, it will be possible for him to visit more eastern parts during next winter. While it is difficult to make exact plans for his travels at present, it may be mentioned that the preliminary programme includes the exploration of the Trucial Coast, probably continuing north to the Qatar peninsula and Hassa country. If possible, a separate trip to southern Oman and Dhufar may be undertaken.

Since the Govt of India is the recognised channel for communicating with the authorities in Oman regarding matters affecting British interests, I should be greatly obliged if you would take the necessary steps to ensure that the local authorities are informed of the intended visit of our entomologist, Mr.

4-
R.C. Maxwell Darling, and requested to assist him in making the
arrangements for his travels.

- 5 -

F. & P. Dept

x 7-245(3)-6/36,
Not final

The Iranian Govt are already interested in the locust problem and have approached the Foreign Office, through the Minister, Tehran, with a proposal to come to an arrangement with the Govt of India with a view to the co-ordination of effective measures calculated to prevent the spread of invasion of locusts in their country. There seems therefore to be little doubt that they will readily extend their co-operation to enable the proposed locust investigations along their coastal areas to be carried out, but it seems advisable that their co-operation should be sought through the usual diplomatic channel, and we may ask the I.C.A.R. Dept to address the India Office in the matter.

2. As regards Mr. Maxwell Darling's visit to Oman and Dhufar, the Pol. Resdt. in the P. Gulf may be addressed as in the draft submitted.

L.H.S.,
13-8-36.

N.S. Alington,
14-8-36.

I think the I.C.A.R. would be interested to see the Iranian Consul General's demarche. We may hope that in return for the information India gives to Iran about locust conditions on the Mekran coast, we may secure the Iranian agreement to join an Indian expert with any investigations made on the Iranian coast of the Persian Gulf and the Gulf of Oman. But we should not be too certain, as Iranian susceptibilities are tender and much tact and patience will be required.

2. When the I.C.A.R. have seen the papers referred to we will, if desired, approach the Tehran Legation in the first instance. We need hardly go through the India Office and Foreign Office unless on being approached H.M. Minister, Tehran advises us to do so.

3. With regard to Oman the draft may issue.

Sd. O.K. Caroe,

15-8-36

(1) Issue

2957-9/26?

On another file of I.C.A.R., an enquiry has been received from the India Office whether the Govt of India have any objection to the Minister, Tehran being instructed to convey to the Iranian Govt the suggestion that they may obtain the services of an Indian Entomologist for the purpose of undertaking survey of the Iranian coastal areas of the Arabian Sea and the Persian Gulf. We have agreed with I.C.A.R.'s proposed reply that the Govt of India will welcome such a proposal. In the circumstances, it does not seem necessary to address the Minister, Tehran on this file.

2. Our file referred to in para 1 of D.S.(F)'s note above has already been seen by I.C.A.R., who have collected and supplied the information required by the Iranian C.G. They may see the file again.

L.H.S., 24-8-36.

Sd. P.C. Hailey,
25-8-36.

Sd. O.K. Caroe,
25-8-36.

I.C.A.R.

Seen and returned with thanks.

Sd. Bazlul Karim,
14-9-36

-7-
Dy. No. 3212-G. (2).

Locust investigation

u/o No. D. 2837-G/36,
dt- 29/9/36.

Some return
of kind
from
M.L.

Our file on the subject has been referred
to the J. C. A. R., who ^{may} see the present
telegram from the Pol. Resid. in the Persian
 Gulf and he asked kindly to furnish
the information required by him.

M 10/9/36

d.s.
10/9/36.

u.s.
h

P. Harey
10-9-36.

J. C. A. R.

J. C. A. R. u.o. No. D. 3212-G/36, 2/11/9/36.

I.C.A.R. DEPT

File No

Date 11 SEP. 1936

Serial on F.I.

Diary No... 769/36/L.B.

(I.C. of A.R.)

AS we have no further information regarding
Mr. Maxwell Darling's programme a telegraphic
enquiry is being made from the Director, Imperial
Institute of Entomology, London. The reply when
received will be passed on to the Foreign and
Political Department.

Haynehan
15. 9. 36.

Foreign and Political Department u/o.

J. C. A. R. u.o. No. D. 769/36/L.B. D/16. 9. 1936.

The requisite information promised by S.C.P.R.
may be awaited.

12/17/36

del
17.9.36.

W.S.

3/29/9

Ant. 30/9

del ant 5/10.

Ant 10/10.
del

R. Harley

20-9-36

NATIONAL ARCHIVES OF INDIA

(Imperial Council of Agricultural
Research Department).

Page 7 ante

Will the Foreign and Political Department
please refer to this Department u.o. No. D.769/36/L.B.
dated the 16th September 1936 regarding Mr. Maxwell
Darling's tour? The Director, Imperial Institute
of Entomology, London, has informed us as follows:-
"Maxwell Darling hopes to arrive Muscat first half
of January 1937, proposes going inland to beginning
of Rubaelkhali and to Qatar and also to Dhogar if
time permits".

Bayne Kerr

F. and P. Department.

I.C.A.R. U.O. I.No. F. 18(1)/36/L.B., dated 1.10.36.

by no. 6669-2/36

SNO 3537-5/36

(Foreign and Political Department).

We may now reply to the telegram at S.No.(2).

Draft submitted.

S.N.

7.10.36.

d.S.

7/10/36.

U.S.

9

B. Harney

8.10.36

(3) - Issue

ans (8/11) 8/11/37
9/10/37

D.No.3869-G/36.

(4)

I.C.A.R. may see u.o. and remove the spare
copy placed below for ^{future} necessary action.

11.11.36.

del
11/14/36.

B. Nailery
11-11-36

C. A. R.

74. Dpt. u.o. No. 3869-8/36 dt-11-11-36

I. C A R D.
FILE NO
DATE 12 NOV. 1936
SERIAL NO
DRAWING NO

(I.C.A.R. Deptt.)

Seen, thanks. The spare copy of the Express letter from the Political Resident No. 2221 dated the 31st 13/245 October 1936 has been removed for necessary action.

Hayne Kern
17-11-36.

F. & P. Deptt.

F. & P. Deptt.
I.C.A.R. u.o. No. F.18(1)/36-L.B. dt. 17.11.36.

~~H.P~~
~~17/11~~
~~ans (1/12)~~
~~17/11~~
~~ans (2/1)~~
~~1/12~~
~~ans (2/2)~~
~~2/1~~
~~ans (2/4)~~
~~2/2~~

(5)

Diary No. 582. G/37.

For information only.

15/6/37
N
US
S

J.R.
15. 2. 37
d.s.
16/2/37.

R. Bailey
17.2.37.

Dy. No. 2005 - G/37. (6)

For information only.

13/6/37
A
A.S. 2.
C.F. 1/9.
d.s.
Record

BR
29/6/37.
d.s.
29.6.37.

William
1737

BR
29/6/37
S

F. & P.

DEPARTMENT.

G. BRANCH.

File No.

Serial No.

Draft Letter
Memorandum
Telegram

Ordinary
Express
Urgent*
Priority
Clear Line†

*Only for
Foreign
Telegrams.

†Not for
Foreign
Telegrams.

No.

Dated

22/8/36

19 .

D-2837-G/36.

To

The Hon. the Political Resident in
the Persian Gulf

Subject: Locust investigations in Oman
and Dhufar by Mr. R.C. Maxwell-
Darling of the Imperial Institute
of Entomology, London.

Sir,

I am directed to forward a copy of
a letter dated the 9th July 1936 from
Sir Guy Marshall, Director, Imperial Insti-
tute of Entomology, London, and to request
that, if you see no objection,
the local authorities in Oman may
be informed of the visit which Mr. Maxwell-
Darling intends to pay to southern Oman
and Dhufar in connection with his locust
investigations, and that he may be afforded
such assistance as may be possible in his
journey to those countries.

I have etc.,

Say-P. L. Harty
Under Secy.

Copy forwarded to the I.C.A.R. for
information.

Bo. etc.
Say-P. L. Harty
L.S.

Class for telegrams

To be issued on

1st Reminder

2nd Reminder

3rd Reminder

Heading:

Case or Diary No.

If post copy of telegram required

Date of despatch of above

List of enclosures

Issued on

24/8

(Code word for telegrams.)

Issue Br.
make
copy of
the letter for the
file

cd
files
19/8

21/8
24/8

By No. 3212-9/36.

(2)
Telegram No.146.

Dated Shiraz, the 8th September

From--Political Resident in the Persian Gulf.

To --Foreign Secy to the Govt of India,
For. and Political Dept.

*S No (1)

Your letter of August 22nd No.D-2837. Please
telegraph approximate date of Maxwell Darling wishes
to visit Souther Oman and Dhofar and how far inland
it is necessary for him to go, if his investigations
are to be of use. Does he propose to go to Qatar
after Southern Oman-Dhofar visit?

(3)

Foreign & Political DEPARTMENT.
General BRANCH.

File No.

Serial No.

Imp
ans 8/11
8/10

Draft Letter
Memorandum
Telegram

Ans 8/10
8/10

G.T.Code.

Class for telegrams

~~Ordinary~~
~~Express~~
~~Urgent*~~
~~Priority~~
~~Clear Line†~~

~~Only for Foreign Telegrams.~~
~~Not for Foreign Telegrams.~~

No. 879 -G. Dated 8th October 1936.

From - Foreign, Simla.

To - Britconsul, Bushire.

To be issued on

Issued on

1st Reminder

2nd Reminder

3rd Reminder

Heading:

Case or Diary No.

If post copy of telegram required

Date of despatch of above

List of enclosures

AL
8.10.
* S.No. (2).

(Code word for telegrams.)

Your telegram dated 8th Sept.,
No. 146. Maxwell Darling hopes to
arrive Muscat first half of January,
proposes going inland to beginning
of Rubaelkhali and to Qatar and also
to Dhogar if time permits.

Copy, with copy of telegram

under reply, forwarded to the I.C.A.F.
for information, in continuation of
endorsement from the F.&P. Dept No.
D. 2837-G/36, dated the 22nd August
1936.

By order, etc.,

Sd. P. C. Hailey
Under Secretary.

S. 5.

MGIPG-SI-325 (CPS) DCF-(G-1432)-24.4 31-50,000 Pads.

TELEGRAM NO. 879-G.

Dated the 8th October 1936.
To - Britconsul, Bushire.

Foreign and Political Deptt.

INDIAN POSTS AND



TELEGRAPHS DEPARTMENT

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NATIONAL ARCHIVE

(4) 8-3869-4136 (4)
GOVERNMENT OF INDIA,

DEPARTMENT.

EXPRESS LETTER

[N. B.—This is an ORIGINAL MESSAGE, sent by post to save telegraphic expense and undue use of the wires, but intended to be treated, on receipt, with the same expedition as if it had been telegraphed. To save time and formalities it is worded and signed as if it had been so despatched.]

FROM

Political Resident,
Bushire.

TO

Foreign, New Delhi.

Repeated to:-

Political, Muscat.

Political, Bahrain.

No. 2221
13/245

Dated 31st October 1936

Visit of Entomologist to Arab Coast
of Persian Gulf.

With reference to your telegram No. 879-G of 8th October, which gave the latest information with regard to the proposed visit of Mr. R.C. Maxwell-Darling, the entomologist in question.

2. As the matter stands Mr. Maxwell-Darling proposes arriving at Muscat during the first half of January and wishes to visit:

- (a) The Trucial Coast
- (b) Qatar
- (c) Hasa
- (d) Southern Oman
- (e) Dhofar.

3/-

3. (c) being part of Sa'udi Arabia is outside the Persian Gulf Residency, and Mr. Maxwell-Darling should apply for permission to travel in that area to His Britannic Majesty's Legation at Jedda.

4. There is no objection to Mr. Maxwell-Darling visiting (a) and (b). How far inland from the coast he will be able to travel is doubtful.

5. With regard to (d). This is not possible - if by this area is meant the interior of the Muscat State. While the coast of the State is under the control of the Sultan the interior is not, and the tribes of that area do not allow Europeans to travel in their territory. Mr. Maxwell-Darling could, however, travel along the coast of the Muscat State except for the area south of Ras-al-Hadd. From here to Dhofar even the coastal area is wild, desolate, and uncontrolled, and unsuitable for European travellers.

6. With regard to (e). This is an outlying part of the Muscat State, and the special permission of the Sultan will have to be obtained. How far inland the Sultan will take the responsibility of allowing Mr. Maxwell-Darling to go, I do not know. The Sultan himself is at Dhofar and the Political Agent, Muscat, is writing to His Highness informing him of the intended visit. Mr. Maxwell-Darling may find some difficulty in getting from Muscat to Dhofar as no steamers touch at the latter place, and the only means of reaching it is by dhow. I understand that Mr. Maxwell-Darling is at present working in the Aden Protectorate and then Hadramaut. In which case he might, provided that the Sultan

gives/-

* cf p. 3 of notes

gives permission, find it more convenient to visit Dhofar before coming to Muscat.

7. During the time Mr. Maxwell-Darling is in areas (a) and (b) he will have to regulate his movements according to the views of the Political Agent, Bahrain, and in areas (d) and (e) according to the views of the Political Agent, Muscat.

8. Conditions of travel along the coastal areas of the Arab Coast of the Gulf are generally speaking not unlike those in the Aden Protectorate. So Mr. Maxwell-Darling should know what to expect.

9. I suggest that Mr. Maxwell-Darling be given the above information, a copy of the letter might be sent to him, and that he be instructed to communicate ^{direct} with the Political Agents, Muscat and Bahrain (who will keep me informed) giving them as long notice as possible of his proposed itinerary, and obtaining from them any further details he may require. Those officers will be pleased to give him all the assistance they can, and to arrange for his accommodation at Muscat and Bahrain when he arrives there: there are of course no hotels or rest houses at these places.

T. C. Lowe

Political Resident in the Persian Gulf.

(5)

Dy. No. 582-9/37

No. F.18(1)/36/L.B.

Imperial Council of Agricultural Research.

New Delhi, the 11th February 1937.

A copy each of the undermentioned papers is forwarded to the Secretary to the Government of India, Foreign and Political Department, for information.

By order,

Samuel Ham.

For Secretary,

Imperial Council of Agricultural Research.

Papers forwarded.

- ps-9 infra (1) Letter from the Locust Research Entomologist to the Imperial Council of Agricultural Research, No. 116, dated the 19th January 1937.
- p 10 infra (2) Letter from the India Office, London, No.E.&O. 196/37, dated the 7th January 1937.
-

Copy of letter No. 116, dated the 19th January 1937, from the Locust Research Entomologist to the Imperial Council of Agricultural Research, Karachi, to the Secretary, Imperial Council of Agricultural Research.

I have the honour to state that Mr. R.C. Maxwell-Darling, Locust Investigator, working under the Imperial Institute of Entomology, London, was at Karachi last week on his way to Muscat from Aden. On getting information from him as to his presence at Karachi, I met him on the 14th at the Killarney Hotel where he was staying. I was told that he had recently visited Port Sudan etc. on the Red Sea Coast, and has thence proceeded to Aden, and had ultimately arrived at Karachi direct from Aden on board a cargo steamer.

I invited him to visit the office on the 15th, when I explained to him the work in progress under our scheme with the help of maps and graphs.

On the 16th, I took him by car to Ambagh, and showed him the "rek" areas round about the station, and also the field-cages and the work in progress at Ambagh.

On the 17th, he left Karachi by the B.I.S.N. steamer S.S. Bamora, for Muscat. Before leaving Karachi, he told me that he felt that the evidence gathered so far in regard to the migratory powers of the 'soliteries' was fairly convincing.

I understood from him that he is to examine the coastal areas of the Muscat area, and also the Pirate Coast (Sharjah area), and the Trucial Coast, and the interior of Hasa on the east coast of Arabia. I believe he would endeavour to cross Arabia across Nejd, and in case he could not do so, he would return via Karachi. In the latter case, I invited him to visit the Gwadar

Copy of a letter No. P.O. 126/37, dated 7th January 1937, from the Secretary, Economic & Overseas Department, to the Secretary, Government of India, Ministry of Agriculture, and Pasni areas on his way back.

Subject:- Local research proposed visit of Mr. H.C. Maxwell-Berling to Saudi Arabia.

I am directed by the Secretary of State for India in Council to forward, for information, copy of Letter from Foreign Office dated 4th January.

the paper noted in the margin, on the above

subject.

I am, Sir,

your obedient servant,

Sd/- Illigible.

for Secretary.

Economic & Overseas Department.

NATIONAL ARCHIVES OF INDIA

(10)

Copy of a letter No.E.& O.196/37, dated the 7th January 1937, from the Secretary, Economic & Overseas Department, India House, London, to the Secretary, Government of India, Imperial Council of Agricultural Research Department,.

Subject:- Locust research proposed visit of Mr. R.C.Maxwell-Darling to Saudi Arabia.

I am directed by the Secretary of State for India in Council to forward, for information, copy of Letter from Foreign Office) the paper noted in the
dated 4th January.) margin, on the above
subject.

put in

I am, Sir,

Your obedient Servant,

Sd/- Illegible.

for Secretary,
Economic & Overseas Department.

No. L.8094/48/405.

No. 284.

The Under-Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs presents his compliments to the Under Secretary of State for India and, by direction of the Secretary of State, transmits herewith copy of the under-mentioned papers.

Foreign Office,

4th January 1937.

Reference to previous correspondence:

Description of Enclosure.

Name and Date.

Subject.

To

Mr. Maxwell -

His Majesty's Representative
Jedda.

Darling's proposed
visit to the
territory of Oman.

Despatch No. 284 of 10th - p. 12 14 1/2
October 1936 (with enclosures)

From His Majesty's Representative

Jedda.

Despatch Nos. 309 and 317 of

28/11/36 and 8/12/36

respectively.

Copies of despatches 309 and 317 to E.A.C.

(Despatch No. 284 sent previously to E.A.C.)

(12)
No. 284.

FOREIGN OFFICE, S.W.1.

10th October, 1936.

Sir,

not traced
With reference to Sir Andrew Ryan's despatch No. 75(483/247/19) of the 15th March last, and to connected correspondence, relative to a journey undertaken in the spring of this year by Mr. R.C. Maxwell-Darling in Saudi Arabia for the purpose of investigating possible breeding sites of the Desert Locust in the Arabian Peninsula, I transmit to you herewith a copy of a letter ^{sp 13-14} No. E.A.C./717 of the 30th ultimo from the Economic Advisory Council regarding the further investigations which the Council hope Mr. Maxwell-Darling may be able to undertake early next year.

p 13-14 infra
2. I request that you will approach the Saudi Arabian Government with a view to obtain the necessary permission for the proposed investigation in their territory and report the result to me in due course.

I am, etc.,

Sd. S. GASELEE.

Sir Reader Bullard, K.C.M.G., C.I.E.,
etc., etc., etc.,
Jedda.

E.A.C./717.

ECONOMIC ADVISORY COUNCIL

2, Whitehall Gardens,

London, S.W.1.

30th September, 1936.

Sir,

unrevised
I am directed by the Economic Advisory Council to refer to their letter (E.A.C./653) of the 25th November, ^{1935?} 1936, on the subject of a journey undertaken in the Spring of this year by Mr. R.C. Maxwell-Darling in Saudi Arabia for the purpose of investigating possible permanent breeding sites of the Desert locust in the Arabian Peninsula, and to state, for the information of Mr. Secretary Eden, that it is desired that Mr. Maxwell-Darling should shortly carry out further investigations on this subject. For this purpose the Council hope that Dr. Maxwell-Darling may be able to visit the territory of Oman early next year arriving at Muscat in the first part of January, travelling thence inland as far as the Ruba-el-Khali and afterwards proceeding to Qatar.

2. The value of Mr. Maxwell-Darling's investigations would be greatly enhanced if he were able to continue his journey from Qatar through Saudi Arabia following the route Qatar-Hofuf-Riadh-Wady Dawasir-Jedda. By this means he would be enabled to carry out a search for the breeding grounds of the Desert locust in areas not included in his previous visit to Saudi Arabia.

3. The Council anticipate that Mr. Maxwell-Darling should have completed his investigations in Oman and would desire to enter Saudi Arabia by about the beginning of March, 1937. It is anticipated that his

The Under-Secretary of State,
Foreign Office.

proposed journey to Jedda would be completed in approximately three months

4. Mr. Maxwell-Darling's previous visit to Saudi Arabia has already yielded valuable information in regard to the possible existence of permanent locust breeding grounds in the areas which ^{he} has so far traversed. It is of great importance that his investigations should now be completed by an examination of other areas in which breeding sites may also possibly be found.

5. The Council accordingly hope that the Secretary of State will be prepared to use his good offices to obtain from the Saudi Arabian Government the necessary permission for Mr. Maxwell-Darling to carry out the proposed investigation.

I am, etc.,

Sd. FRANCIS HEMMING.

(15)
No. 309

(2025/247/27)

27th November, 1936.

BRITISH LEGATION,

JEDDA.

28th November, 1936.

Sir,

prizants In accordance with the instructions which I have had the honour to receive in your despatch No. ^{284?} 384 (L6445/48/405) dated 10th October, regarding the proposal of Mr. Maxwell-Darling to continue in 1937 the investigations into the problem of the desert locust which he began in Saudi Arabia this year, I am approaching the Saudi Government for facilities for the proposed visit to Hofuf and the Dawasir.

2. It was not clear to me whether the Oman-Qatar portion of the expedition would involve entry into Saudi territory, and in view of the complications which such entry might involve I thought it well to deal with this point in letters to Mr. Maxwell-Darling and the Honourable the Political Resident in the Persian Gulf of which copies are enclosed for your information.

I have, etc.,

Sd. R.W. BULLARD.

The Right Honourable Anthony Eden, M.C.M.P.
etc., etc., etc.,

No. 2022/247/25.

27th November, 1936.

(Dear Mr. Maxwell-Darling),

p. 12 unfiled
I received your letter of 22nd October, and also an official despatch from the Foreign Office, about your proposal to visit Saudi Arabia again next year to continue your investigations on the subject of the desert locusts. I informed Fuad Bay Hanza orally on the 25th November and have now followed the question up in writing in order to obtain the views of the Saudi Arab Government. I doubt whether they will approve your proposal to travel from Hofuf to Dawasir across the desert. They would have to provide a considerable escort which would have to return to Hofuf from the Dawasir, and as you do not suggest that an examination of the intervening country is necessary to the success of your expedition, there is little to urge in favour of the cross-desert trip if the Saudi Government should raise objections.

In my note to the Ministry of Foreign Affairs I have not mentioned your Oman expedition. According to the letter addressed to the Foreign Office by the Economic Advisory Council, you propose to travel inland from Muscat as far as the Ruba' al Khali and afterwards to proceed to Qatar. It does not say whether you propose to travel by land to Qatar from some point inland from Muscat, or to return to the coast and to go from there to Qatar by sea. Even if you travel by land the journey need not involve entry into Saudi territory, and I have therefore not mentioned the first half of your expedition to the Ministry of Foreign Affairs. I assume that you are in communication with the Political Agent at Muscat and / or the Political Resident in the Persian Gulf, Bushire, regarding your

proposed visit to Oman and Qatar, and you will presumably be guided by the advice of the Political Agent at Muscat as to the routes to follow until you reach Qatar.

Yours sincerely,

R. W. BULLARD.

R.C. Maxwell-Darling Esq.,
Khartoum.

No. 2023/247/36.

BRITISH LEGATION,

JEDDA.

27th November, 1936.

Sir,

I have the honour to transmit herewith a copy of a letter which I have addressed to Mr. R.C. Maxwell-Darling regarding an expedition which he proposes to make in Saudi Arabia next spring to continue his investigations into the problem of the desert locust which he began in this country in the spring of this year by journeys radiating from Jedda and ending with a trip to Jizan.

I enclose also a copy of a letter from the Economic Advisory Council to which reference is made in my letter to Mr. Maxwell-Darling.

2. In view of the negotiations which have been going on for some time as to the frontiers between Saudi Arabia and the territories of the coastal rulers on the Persian Gulf it appeared to me undesirable to ask the Saudi Government for permission for Mr. Maxwell-Darling to enter Saudi territory on that side unless it was essential to him to visit some place which we admit to be in Saudi territory, lest they should use the opportunity to assert sovereignty over some disputed area, e.g. by means of letters of recommendation to persons whom we do not regard as under their authority. To judge from the map it should be possible for Mr. Maxwell Darling to pursue his investigations from Oman to Qatar by land without touching what is indubitably Saudi territory, except perhaps when he gets west of 52 degrees. E. ~~xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx~~
~~xxxxxxx~~ If it should prove to be essential for him to enter Saudi Arabia on his way to Qatar there would be plenty of time for me to receive a telegram from Muscat or Bushire and to approach the Saudi authorities for the required facilities.

3. I am sending copies of this letter and of its enclosure to the Foreign Office and to the Political Agent at Muscat. I am also sending to Muscat a copy of the letter from the Economic Advisory Council.

I have, etc.,

Sd. R.W. Bullard.

The Hon' ble the Political Resident,

In the Persian Gulf,

Bushire.

No. 317
(2090/247/30)

(20)
BRITISH LEGATION,
JEDDA.
8th December, 1936.

Sir,

x
p 15 ante
In continuation of my despatch No. 309, dated 28th November regarding Mr. Maxwell-Darling's proposl to continue ^{his} investigations into the problem of the desert locust in Saudi Arabia, I have the honour to transmit a copy of a second letter which I have sent to Mr. Darling. The Saudi authorities state that "practical difficulties" make it impossible to allow him to visit the Dawasir, though they raise no objection to his crossing Arabia to Jedda after finishing his work in the Qatar-Hofuf region. They may think that the permission to cross Arabia is worthless if the Dawasir is not to be visited.

2. What the "practical difficulties" may be I cannot say. If they were difficulties of transport, escort, etc. one would expect the reply to be more precise, since the vague expression it uses is bound to invite speculation. There may be a general objection to allowing Europeans to wander about in the interior, but in fact the work of the mining engineers of the Saudi Arabian Mining Syndicate Ltd. has taken them a long way into the interior and even within a short distance of Medina and Mecca. No local disturbance or discontent has been heard of that might explain the desire to keep a European away from the Dawasir, and the supposition which connects the refusal of Mr. Darling's application with the intention Ibn Saud is believed to have, to keep a close watch upon the Yomen for fear that internal troubles there may affect Saudi Arabia, is perhaps far fetched. When I next see Fuad Bay, who after *spending*

a few days in Jedda has vanished into the interior for several weeks, I will ask whether the difficulties are likely to disappear, and it may be that their nature will be revealed in the course of conversation.

3. Copies of this despatch and of its enclosure *Political Resident in the Persian Gulf at Bushire* have been sent to the *Political agent at Muscat*.

I have etc.,

Sd. R.W. Bullard.

The Right Honourable Anthony Eden, M.C., M.P.,

etc., etc., etc.,

Yours sincerely,

Sd. R.W. Bullard.

R.W. Bullard, Esq.,

No.2069/247/29.

6th December 1936.

(Dear Mr. Maxwell Darling),

pp. 16-17 ante. You will have received my letter of November 27th about your proposed visit to Saudi Arabia next year. The reply of the Saudi Government to the enquiry which I addressed to them on your behalf has now reached me. They raise no objection to your studying the country between Qatar and Hofuf, nor to your proceeding from there via Riyadh to Jedda, but they are unable, on account of "practical difficulties", to agree to your visiting the Dawasir, I will enquire later whether the difficulties have disappeared, or are likely to disappear by the date when you would be wishing to visit Dawasir, and if the reply is favourable (which seems unlikely), it can be sent to Muscat or whichever other place on the Persian Gulf you select as your headquarters.

Yours sincerely,

Sd. R.W. Bullard.

R.C. Maxwell Darling, Esq.,
Khartoum.

(6)

Dec. 2005-6/37

No.F.18(1)/37/L.B.

Imperial Council of Agricultural Research .

Simla the 24th June 1937.

A copy of the undermentioned paper is forwarded
to the External Affairs Department for information, in
continuation of this Department ~~E~~ndorsement
No.F.18(1)^x/36/L.B., dated the 11th February 1937.

XS. No. (5)

By Order,

S C Sarkar
for Secretary.

List of papers forwarded.

Pp. 24-26 infra
Letter from the India Office, No.E.&O.3722/37,
dated the 1st June 1937 and enclosures.

E enclosure to S. No. (6)

(24)

Copy of letter No.E.& O.3722/37 dated the 1st June 1937 from the Secretary, Economic and Overseas Department London, to the Secretary, to the Imperial Council of Agricultural Research Department.

.....

Proposed investigation of desert locust in Saudi Arabia.

x corr. p. 10 auto.

With reference to the letter from this office, No.E.& O.196/37 dated 7th January, 1937, I am directed by the Secretary of State to forward, for information, copy of the papers noted in the margin, on the above subject.

From Foreign
Office dated
24th May 1937
with enclo-
sure.

pp. 25-26 infra

.....

No.L3119/91/405.

The Under Secretary of State for Foreign Affairs presents his compliments to the Under Secretary of State for India and, by direction of the Secretary of State, transmits herewith copy of the under-mentioned paper.

Foreign Office,

24th May, 1937.

Reference to previous correspondence:

Foreign Office letter L.8094/48/405 of 4th January, 1937.

Description of Enclosure.

NAME AND DATE

SUBJECT

b.26 *infra*
From

P.26 infra.

H.M. Representative,
Jedda
No.84 of
2nd May, 1937.

Proposed investigation
of desert locust in Saudi
Arabia.

Similar letter sent to Economic Advisory Council.

A copy of this despatch is being sent to Cairo.

No. 84.

(716/247/35).

British Legation,

Jedda.

2nd May, 1937.

Sir,

xcorr. pp. 20-21 aut.

With reference to my despatch No.317^x of the 8th December regarding Mr. Maxwell Darling's proposed investigation of the desert locust in Saudi Arabia, I have the honour to inform you that though the Saudi Arab Government raised no objection to his journey across Arabia from Hofuf to Jedda, difficulties over transport proved in the end insuperable.

2. The Saudi authorities suggested that as there might be no transport on the other side of Arabia it would be advisable for the Legation to arrange with the National Arab Car Company for the despatch of cars from Jedda. The Car Company were approached early in March but when they were requested, in April to send the cars, they admitted that they had no cars fit to make the trip. They suggested that they should buy two new cars in Bahrain and hire them out to Mr. Darling, but the large sum (£150 gold) they demanded for the hire and the delay involved compelled Mr. Darling to cancel his journey and to return by another route.

3. A copy of this despatch is being sent to Cairo.

I have, etc.,

(Signed) R.W.BULLARD.

The Right Hon. Anthony Eden, M.C., M.P.,

&c., &c., &c.